

Kapil Kumawat

Senior Director of Engineering

Engineering leadership for B2B SaaS scale — from zero-to-one team builds to global org leadership and successful acquisition.

17+ Years | B2B SaaS | Frontend Architecture & Engineering Leadership | Jaipur, India

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Harness · 2020–2023

Staff Engineer → Senior Engineering Manager

- Founding team → 30+ engineers globally in under 18 months
- 0% → 70% test coverage; established TDD culture for full platform rewrite
- Pipeline step framework: 500+ steps, core unchanged for 6+ years

Goldcast → Cvent · 2023–2026

Senior Director of Engineering

- Developed 3 EMS; transitioned 2 ICs into engineering manager roles
- 0% → 80% test coverage across all products via CI/CD improvements
- Rebuilt vendor feature using 22 AI agents — 90% coverage, under \$200
- 2× contract renewal through direct technical escalation leadership

ServiceNow & AppDynamics · 2016–2020

Founding India Engineer

- Built India engineering function from zero at both companies
- Scaled each team to 10+ developers within 9–12 months
- 0% → 80% test coverage at both organisations via CI/CD

01 | Frontend Engineering Highlights

- Architected a proprietary, extensible **pipeline step framework** at Harness using Abstract Factory design patterns during the 2020 full product rewrite — solving a critical QA bottleneck where any single step change triggered complete re-validation of all 65+ steps, each requiring 2 weeks of testing and recurring regression failures.
- Designed each pipeline step as a fully isolated, independently manageable unit — enabling zero cross-step impact on change or addition, zero performance regression, and **fewer than 10 bugs raised against the core framework** across its entire lifetime.
- Framework proved so robust that the **core has remained unchanged for 6+ years**, now supporting 500+ pipeline steps across Harness CD, CI, and Feature Flags — effectively a proprietary internal standard at Harness.
- Drove unit test automation from **0% to 70% coverage** at Harness — coaching the team on TDD and establishing a culture of test discipline that underpinned the entire platform rewrite.

02 | Building Products from Scratch

- Led the complete ground-up rewrite of the **Harness platform UI in 2020** — architecting a new frontend designed to scale from a single CI/CD product to a unified multi-product platform spanning CD, CI, Feature Flags, and beyond.
- Designed and built the **core pipeline step framework, shared UI component library, custom router framework, and build system with quality controls** — the foundational architecture on which the entire Harness frontend still operates today.
- Engineered a **proprietary string externalization framework** for React using YAML, mustache.js templating, and TypeScript; enabling documentation teams to manage thousands of UI strings with zero developer intervention. Published on the Harness engineering blog.
- Delivered **100% performant pipeline UI** with zero performance regression across the rewrite, even as product surface expanded 4–5× in scope.

03 | Managing and Building Teams

- Served as **founding UI engineer in India** at both ServiceNow (Performance Analytics BU) and AppDynamics (Cisco) — building the frontend engineering function from zero in each organisation, scaling to **10+ developers within 9–12 months** in both cases.
- At Harness, joined as one of the first 7–8 UI engineers and grew into managing the **entire global UI engineering organisation within 18–20 months** — ultimately leading **30+ frontend developers across 5 countries** (Ireland, Serbia, US, Brazil, and Canada).
- Improved test coverage from **0% to 80%** at ServiceNow and AppDynamics, and from **0% to 70%** at Harness — consistently establishing CI/CD discipline and TDD culture as a founding engineering priority at each organisation.
- Conducted **thousands of technical interviews** and established a strong conviction that raw coding ability combined with learning agility is a stronger hiring signal than current framework knowledge.
- Established a **structured intern-to-engineer pipeline** — daily 30-minute coaching with milestone-based progression — converting **20+ interns at Harness** and a further **6+ at Goldcast** into production-ready engineers.

04 | Client & Customer Facing Experience

- Served as **engineering-side owner of all customer relationships** at Goldcast for 18+ months — acting as the senior technical escalation point across the entire customer base.
- Managed a critical escalation with one of the **world's top financial institutions** — when a platform issue during a live event forced the client to abandon Goldcast mid-event, personally de-escalated the situation and restored confidence with a clear recovery commitment.
- Conducted a **2-hour live technical session** with the client the following day — resolved 2–3 outstanding demands in real time, delivered immediate fixes, and personally assumed full account ownership.
- Outcome: the client **renewed at 2× their previous contract value** — a six-figure deal — driven entirely by trust rebuilt through hands-on technical leadership and personal commitment.

05 | Technology Innovations, AI & Scale

- Contributed to **Harness achieving 8× ARR scale** during a 3.5-year tenure — joining as Principal/Staff Engineer and exiting as Senior Engineering Manager having helped architect the core platform supporting this growth.
- Part of the Goldcast leadership team that drove strong revenue growth, culminating in a **successful acquisition by Cvent** — one of the world's leading event technology platforms.
- Following a **12-hour vendor outage** with no meaningful support, stepped back into hands-on development and **rebuilt the entire feature set in-house using Claude AI (22 agents)** — delivered with 90% unit test coverage, improved UX, and total build cost under \$200.
- Drove **significant annual cost savings** by migrating observability tooling across 6+ products to Coralogix at roughly one-quarter of the previous annual cost, and feature flag management from LaunchDarkly to Harness Feature Flags.
- Became a **trusted technical closer for the sales organisation** — regularly engaged to unblock renewals and new acquisitions, including contracts with two of the top AI companies currently operating in the market.
- Presented a **formal annual cost and revenue impact review** to leadership for 3 consecutive years — quantifying engineering's direct contribution to company P&L.

06 | Coaching Senior Managers & Succession Planning

- Managed and developed **3 engineering managers at Goldcast** — owning their growth, decision-making frameworks, and leadership effectiveness as direct reports.
- Successfully transitioned **2 Individual Contributors to Engineering Managers** at Goldcast — identifying leadership potential early, creating progressive ownership opportunities, and building team confidence in their authority.
- At Harness, identified and invested in **Yunus AM**, a Senior IC, as a future engineering leader — structured 1-year coaching on people management. Yunus went on to become **UI Engineering Manager at SigNoz**, successfully leading a large frontend team.
- Recognised internally at Goldcast as the **go-to leader for people confidence and retention** — trusted by executive leadership to step into sensitive conversations with engineers at risk.

07 | Working with Global Partners & Leadership

- During the 2020 Harness platform rewrite, conducted a **6-hour live coding session with Jyoti Bansal (CEO & Co-founder, Harness)** and the UX Head — starting at 11 PM — to prototype the first visual direction of the new platform.
- Operated across **Ireland, Serbia, US, Brazil, and Canada** as engineering manager for Harness's global UI organisation — managing delivery, culture, and team development across significant time zone and cultural differences.
- At Goldcast, became **executive leadership's trusted partner for critical people retention** — consistently identified as the person best placed to engage and retain high-value engineers at risk of leaving.

08 | Leadership Philosophy

Leadership is multiplication, not control

Make 10 people 10× more effective — not make all 10 decisions.

Build systems that outlast individuals

The Harness pipeline framework built in 2020 runs unchanged today across 500+ steps.

Customer value drives business value

Revenue and growth are downstream of consistently solving customer problems.

Ownership requires empowerment

Accountability without authority is frustration. Authority without accountability is chaos.

Leaders create more leaders

A leader's success is measured by the leaders they develop, not the decisions they make.

Hire for slope, coach for intercept

Learning velocity tells you where someone will go. Bet on trajectory, not starting point.

